

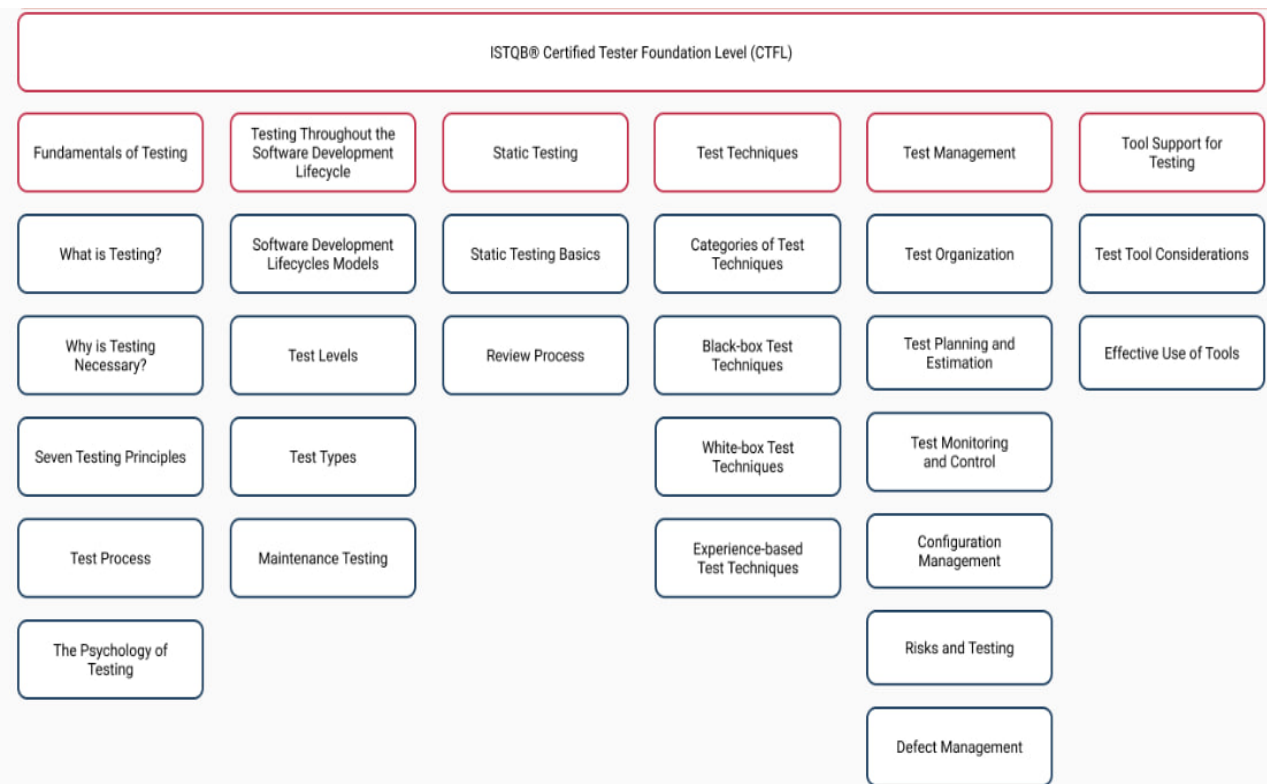
Certified Tester Foundation Level 4.0 (CTFL)

INTRODUCTION

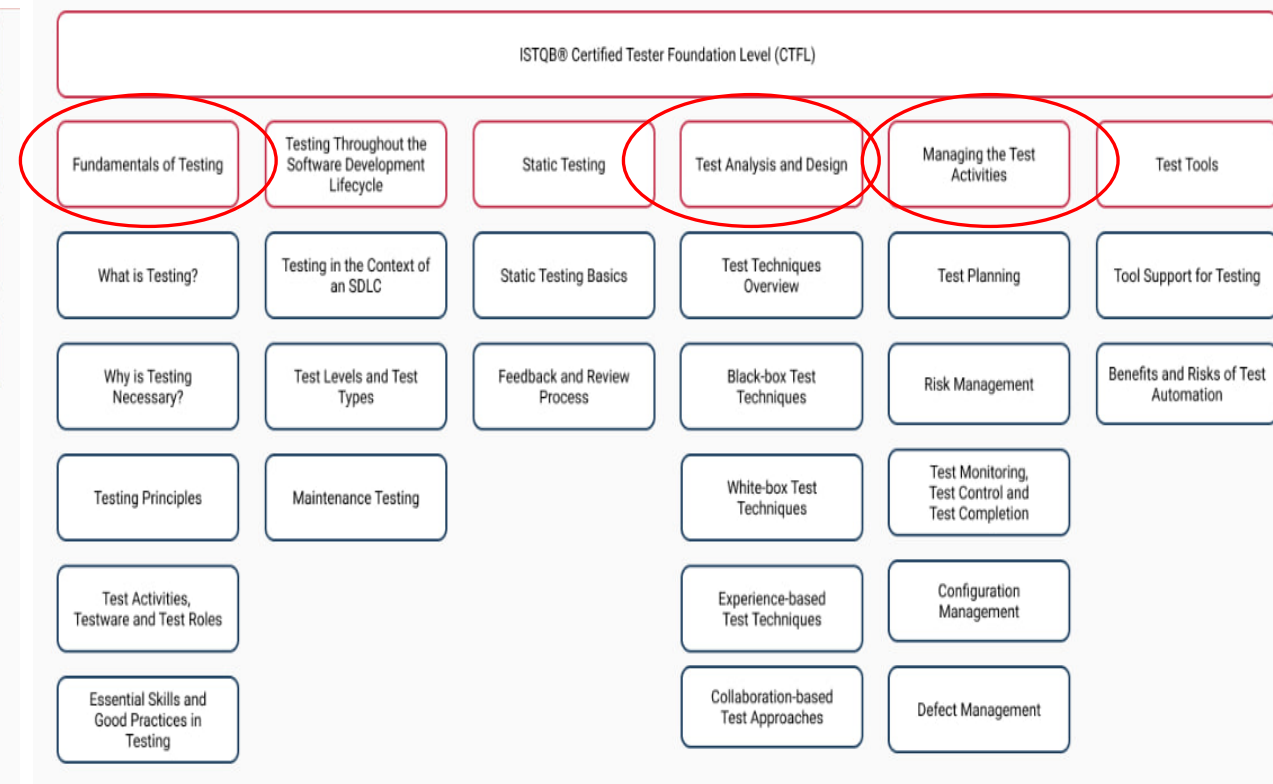
Introduction

- The Foundation Level qualification is aimed at anyone involved in software testing.
- This includes people in roles such as testers, test analysts, test engineers, test consultants, test managers, user acceptance testers, and software developers.
- This Foundation Level qualification is also appropriate for anyone who wants a basic understanding of software testing, such as product owners, project managers, quality managers, software development managers, business analysts, IT directors and management consultants.
- Holders of the Foundation Certificate will be able to go on to higher-level software testing certifications – Advanced Level (CTAL).
- The certification has lifetime validity with no renewal required.
- Name of the certification holder will be published:
<https://mstb.org/directory/>

CTFL SYLLABUS v3.1 vs. v4.0



v3.1



V4.0

Examinable Learning Objectives and Cognitive Levels of Knowledge

In general, all contents of this syllabus are examinable at a K1 level. That is, the candidate may be asked to recognize, remember, or recall a keyword or concept mentioned in any of the six chapters. The knowledge levels of the specific learning objectives are shown at the beginning of each chapter, and classified as follows:

- K1: remember
- K2: understand
- K3: apply

Question Timing Suggestion

K-Level	Number of Questions	Question Timing in minutes	Total Time by K-Level (Approximate)
K1	8	1	8
K2	24	1	24
K3	8	3	24
TOTALS	40		56

CTFL 4.0 RELEASES

The ISTQB Foundation Level Syllabus 2018 version 3.1 was released in 2019. The ISTQB Foundation Level Syllabus 4.0 (2023) was released in 2023. The two syllabuses are very similar, but there are some important differences:

ISTQB Foundation Level Syllabus 2018 version 3.1	ISTQB Foundation Level Syllabus 4.0 (2023)
Does not include Agile testing	Includes Agile testing
Focuses on traditional testing approaches	Focuses on risk-based testing
Does not include some of the latest testing techniques	Includes some of the latest testing techniques
Is a more comprehensive and up-to-date resource for software testers	Is a more comprehensive and up-to-date resource for software testers

The Foundation Level Certificate Exam 4.0

- The Foundation Level Certificate exam will be based on this syllabus.
- The format of the exam is multiple choice. There are 40 questions. To pass the exam, at least **65% of the questions (i.e., 26 questions)** must be answered correctly.

CTFL v3.1 Chapters (Mins)	Total No of Qs	CTFL 4.0 Chapters (Mins)	Total No of Qs
Chapter 1: Fundamentals of Testing (175 mins)	7	Chapter 1: Fundamental of Testing (180 mins)	8
Chapter 2: Testing Throughout the Software Development Lifecycle (100 mins)	6	Chapter 2: Testing Throughout the Software Development Lifecycle (130 mins)	6
Chapter 3: Static Testing (135 mins)	3	Chapter 3: Static Testing (80 mins)	4
Chapter 4: Test Techniques (330 mins)	12	Chapter 4: Test Analysis And Design (390 mins)	11
Chapter 5: Test Management (225 mins)	8	Chapter 5: Managing The Test Activities (335 mins)	9
Chapter 6: Tool Support for Testing (40 mins)	4	Chapter 6: Test Tools (20 mins)	2
TOTAL: 16 hrs 45 minutes	40	TOTAL: 18 hrs 55 minutes	40

CTFL Exam Questions Distribution

Chapter 1

Question Distribution	K-Level	Number of Questions per LO (group)*	Suggested Points per Question	
Chapter 1				
FL-1.1.1	K1	1	1	There is a total of 8 questions required for Chapter 1. K1 = 2 K2 = 6 K3 = 0 Number of points for this chapter = 8
FL-1.2.2	K1			
FL-1.5.2	K1			
FL-1.1.2	K2	1	1	
FL-1.2.1				
FL-1.2.3				
FL-1.3.1	K2	1	1	
FL-1.4.1	K2	3	1	
FL-1.4.2				
FL-1.4.3				
FL-1.4.4				
FL-1.4.5				
FL-1.5.1	K2	1	1	
FL-1.5.3				

CTFL Exam Questions Distribution

Chapter 2

Question Distribution	K-Level	Number of Questions per LO (group)*	Suggested Points per Question	
Chapter 2				
FL-2.1.2	K1	1	1	There is a total of 6 questions required for Chapter 2. K1 = 2 K2 = 4 K3 = 0 Number of points for this chapter = 6
FL-2.1.3	K1	1	1	
FL-2.2.1	K2	1	1	
FL-2.2.2				
FL-2.2.3	K2	1	1	
FL-2.3.1				
FL-2.1.1	K2	1	1	
FL-2.1.6				
FL-2.1.4	K2	1	1	
FL-2.1.5				

CTFL Exam Questions Distribution

Chapter 3

Question Distribution	K-Level	Number of Questions per LO (group)*	Suggested Points per Question	
Chapter 3				
FL-3.1.1	K1	2	1	There is a total of 4 questions required for Chapter 3. K1 = 2 K2 = 2 K3 = 0 Number of points for this chapter = 4
FL-3.2.1				
FL-3.2.3				
FL-3.2.5				
FL-3.1.2	K2	1	1	
FL-3.1.3				
FL-3.2.2	K2	1	1	
FL-3.2.4				

CTFL Exam Questions Distribution

Chapter 4

Question Distribution	K-Level	Number of Questions per LO (group)*	Suggested Points per Question	
Chapter 4				
FL-4.1.1	K2	1	1	There is a total of 11 questions required for Chapter 4. K1 = 0 K2 = 6 K3 = 5 Number of points for this chapter = 11
FL-4.3.1	K2	2	1	
FL-4.3.2				
FL-4.3.3				
FL-4.4.1	K2	2	1	
FL-4.4.2				
FL-4.4.3				
FL-4.5.1	K2	1	1	
FL-4.5.2				
FL-4.2.1	K3	5	1	
FL-4.2.2				
FL-4.2.3				
FL-4.2.4				
FL-4.5.3				

CTFL Exam Questions Distribution

Chapter 5

Question Distribution	K-Level	Number of Questions per LO (group)*	Suggested Points per Question	
Chapter 5				
FL-5.1.2	K1	1	1	There is a total of 9 questions required for Chapter 5. K1 = 1 K2 = 5 K3 = 3 Number of points for this chapter = 9
FL-5.1.6				
FL-5.2.1				
FL-5.3.1	K2	1	1	
FL-5.1.1				
FL-5.1.3				
FL-5.1.7	K2	1	1	
FL-5.2.2	K2	1	1	
FL-5.2.3				
FL-5.2.4				
FL-5.3.2	K2	1	1	
FL-5.3.3				
FL-5.4.1	K2	1	1	
FL-5.1.4	K3	3	1	
FL-5.1.5				
FL-5.5.1				

CTFL Exam Questions Distribution

Chapter 6

Question Distribution	K-Level	Number of Questions per LO (group)*	Suggested Points per Question	
Chapter 6				
FL-6.1.1	K2	1	1	There is a total of 2 question required for Chapter 6. K1 = 1 K2 = 1 K3 = 0 Number of points for this chapter = 2
FL-6.2.1	K1	1	1	

CTFL v3.1/v4.0 EXAMINATION RESULTS

2023-2025

YEAR	TOTAL STUDENTS	PASSED	FAILED	%
(2023) CTFL v3.1	31	7	21	23%
(2024) CTFL v4.0	31	10	21	32%
(2025) CTFL v4.0	31	19	12	61.3%

CTFL v3.1 EXAMINATION 2023

Knowledge Deficiency Report



Candidate:

Subject: EN-ISTQB MSTB CTFL 2018 Set 1+3 New NN

Date: 18/01/2024

Location: MSTB

Result: 62.5 % (failed)

Example of distribution
of points achieved

Topic	Amount of questions	Points achieved	Max. points	Percent
1 Fundamentals of Testing	8	5.00	8.00	62.50
2 Testing Throughout the Software Development Lifecycle	5	5.00	5.00	100.00
3 Static Testing	5	4.00	5.00	80.00
4 Test Techniques	10	7.00	10.00	70.00
5 Test Management	10	4.00	10.00	40.00
6 Tool Support for Testing	2	0.00	2.00	0.00
Total	40	25.00	40.00	62.50

CTFL v4.0 EXAMINATION 2024

GASQ

Knowledge Deficiency Report

Candidate:

Subject: EN-ISTQB CTFL 4.0 SetA-2 V1.3

Date: 30/09/2024

Location: LTS3-GASQ Zentrale

Result: 62.5 % (failed)

You need at least 65 % to pass the test.

Topic	Amount of questions	Points achieved	Max. points	Percent
LO 1	8	4.00	8.00	50.00
LO 2	6	3.00	6.00	50.00
LO 3	4	2.00	4.00	50.00
LO 4	11	6.00	11.00	54.55
LO 5	9	8.00	9.00	88.89
LO 6	2	2.00	2.00	100.00
Total	40	25.00	40.00	62.50

Example of distribution of points achieved

CTFL v4.0 EXAMINATION 2024

GASQ

Knowledge Deficiency Report

Candidate:

Subject: EN-ISTQB CTFL 4.0 SetA-2 V1.3

Date: 30/09/2024

Location: LTS3-GASQ Zentrale

Result: 87.5 % (passed)

You need at least 65 % to pass the test.

Topic	Amount of questions	Points achieved	Max. points	Percent
LO 1	8	8.00	8.00	100.00
LO 2	6	6.00	6.00	100.00
LO 3	4	4.00	4.00	100.00
LO 4	11	8.00	11.00	72.73
LO 5	9	7.00	9.00	77.78
LO 6	2	2.00	2.00	100.00
Total	40	35.00	40.00	87.50

Example of distribution of points achieved

CTFL v4.0 EXAMINATION 2025

GASQ

Knowledge Deficiency Report

Candidate:

Subject: EN-ISTQB CTFL 4.0 2025 v6

Date: 25/09/2025

Location: LTS3-GASQ Zentrale

Result: 62.5 % (failed)

You need at least 65 % to pass the test.

Topic	Amount of questions	Points achieved	Max. points	Percent
1. Fundamentals of Testing	8	4.00	8.00	50.00
2. Testing Throughout the Software Development Lifecycle	6	5.00	6.00	83.33
3. Static Testing	4	2.00	4.00	50.00
4. Test Analysis and Design	11	9.00	11.00	81.82
5. Managing the Test Activities	9	4.00	9.00	44.44
6. Test Tools	2	1.00	2.00	50.00
Total	40	25.00	40.00	62.50

Example of distribution of points achieved

CTFL v4.0 EXAMINATION 2025

GASQ

Knowledge Deficiency Report

Candidate:

Subject: EN-ISTQB CTFL 4.0 2025 v6

Date: 25/09/2025

Location: LTS3-GASQ Zentrale

Result: 82.5 % (passed)

You need at least 65 % to pass the test.

Topic	Amount of questions	Points achieved	Max. points	Percent
1. Fundamentals of Testing	8	6.00	8.00	75.00
2. Testing Throughout the Software Development Lifecycle	6	6.00	6.00	100.00
3. Static Testing	4	2.00	4.00	50.00
4. Test Analysis and Design	11	9.00	11.00	81.82
5. Managing the Test Activities	9	8.00	9.00	88.89
6. Test Tools	2	2.00	2.00	100.00
Total	40	33.00	40.00	82.50

Example of distribution of points achieved

ALL THE BEST!

Any questions?